

Suffixes

A suffix is added to the end of a root—which is either a whole word or part of a word—and changes its meaning or its part of speech. For example, adding the suffix *-ant* (meaning a person who performs an action) to the end of the word *account* results in a new word with a new meaning: *accountant*. On the other hand, the verb *exist* becomes the noun *existence* when the suffix *-ence* (“state of”) is added.

REAL WORLD

Techno-prefixes

New affixes appear in English all the time, largely due to rapidly changing technology. For example, the prefix *e-* (meaning “electronic”) was created to form words such as *e-mail* and *e-commerce*. Similarly, the prefix *cyber-*, which refers to information technology, is used in the words *cyberspace* and *cybercafé*.



Suffixes	Meaning	Examples
-able, -ible	able to	sustainable, sensible
-acy	state or quality	conspiracy
-age	action of	advantage
-age	collection	assemblage
-al	act of	denial
-al, -ial	having characteristics of	seasonal, controversial
-ance, -ence	state of	defiance, competence
-ant, -ent	person who performs an action	accountant, student
-ate	become	inflate
-cian	profession of	technician
-cy	state of being	accuracy
-dom	place or state of being	freedom
-ed	past tense	stopped
-en	made of	golden
-en	become	brighten
-ent	state of being	different
-er, -or	person who performs an action	drummer, investigator
-er	more	shorter
-ery	action of	robbery
-ery	place of	bakery
-esque	reminiscent of	picturesque
-est	the most	shortest
-ette	small	maisonette
-ful	full of	cheerful
-hood	state of	childhood
-ia, -y	state of	amnesia, monarchy

Suffixes	Meaning	Examples
-ic, -tic,	having	historic, poetic,
-ical	characteristics of	radical
-ice	state or quality	justice
-ify	make	magnify
-ing	present participle	hopping
-ish	having the quality of	childish
-ism	the belief in	modernism
-ist	one who	artist
-ite	one connected with	socialite
-ity, -ty	quality of	reality, society
-ive, -ative,	tending to	passive, superlative,
-itive		sensitive
-less	without	useless
-like	resembling	childlike
-ling	small	halfling
-ly	how something is	friendly
-ment	condition of, act of	entertainment
-ness	state of	happiness
-ous, -eous,	having qualities of	ridiculous, nauseous,
-ious		curious
-s, -es	more than one	otters, foxes
-ship	state of	friendship
-sion,	state of being	intrusion, permission,
-ssion, -tion		classification
-some	tending to	cumbersome
-ward	in a direction	backward
-y	characterized by	stormy